UX
Te Ao Māori
Sustainable

Course Work

ReKraft

Connect, Circulate, Cultivate

Kaitiakitanga in everyday upcycling.

View Prototype

Overview

Kaitiakitanga × SDG 12: Responsible Consumption & Production

ReKraft is a values-anchored mobile concept that translates Kaitiakitanga—the Māori principle of guardianship—into practical community action. The project integrates Te Ao Māori with SDG 12 to close the intent–action gap in sustainability by enabling people to share creative reuse, trade or share materials and DIY items, and learn cultural and environmental values.

As a PM and UX designer, I led the research and design framework, defined the information architecture and user flows, produced low-to-high-fidelity prototypes and brand/visual assets, and validated a cohesive "share–trade–learn" pathway that reduces waste, extends item lifecycles, and fosters community stewardship.

Client
MUXD

Timeline
5 Weeks

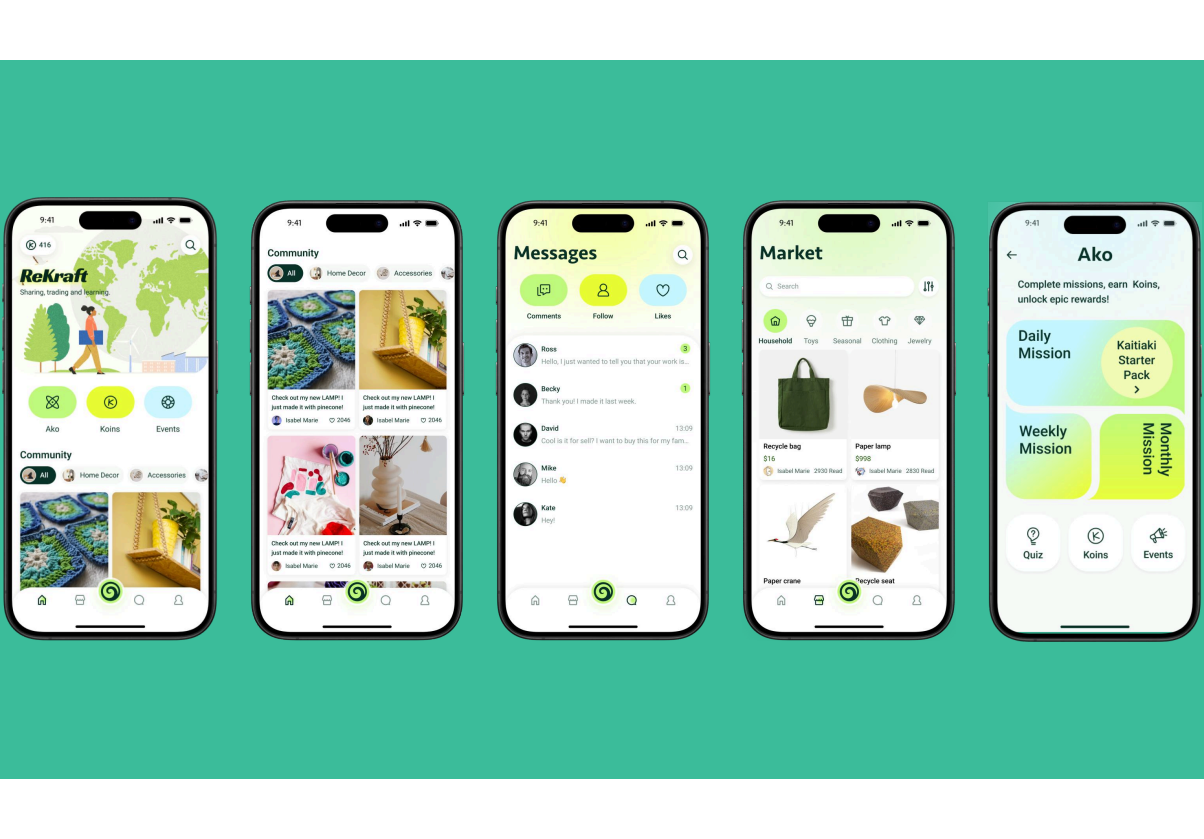
Role
Project Management
UX Research
UX/UI Design
Usability Testing

Tools
Figma
Miro
Linearity Curve
Office365

Team
4 UX Designers

Skills

- Project management
- Concept & Brand
- Prototyping
- Information Architecture
- User flow
- Digital Accessibility (WCAG)
- UI Design
- Marketplace UX


ReKraft
Sharing, trading and learning
Ako
Koins
Events
Community
Home Decor
Accessories
Messages
Comments
Follow
Likes
Market
Household
Toys
Seasonal
Clothing
Jewelry
Recycle bag
Paper lamp
Paper crane
Recycle seat
Ako
Complete missions, earn Koins, unlock epic rewards!
Daily Mission
Kaitiaki Starter Pack
Weekly Mission
Monthly Mission
Quiz

Problem

Intent–Action gap in sustainability

Although public awareness of sustainability is rising, people lack tools, time, skills, and cultural grounding to consistently upcycle or reuse. Mainstream platforms rarely blend creative reuse, community exchange, and Māori values, creating a gap between good intentions and daily actions.

Intention vs. Action
Users may want to be sustainable but lack the know-how, skills, and easy resources to consistently reuse materials and reduce waste in their daily lives.

Lack of Repurposing Inspiration and Ideas
Users might struggle to see the potential in their discarded items or lack creative ideas for repurposing them. This leads to reusable materials being thrown away.

Skill and Knowledge Deficiencies
Many individuals lack the specific skills (e.g., basic sewing, simple repairs, upcycling techniques) needed to confidently undertake DIY repurposing projects.

Limited Access to Sustainable Materials and Tools
Users may not know where to find sustainable materials or have easy access to the necessary tools for repurposing, especially within their local communities.

Lack of Community Support and Shared Motivation
Individuals trying to adopt more sustainable practices may feel isolated or lack a sense of community support to stay motivated and share their experiences.

Disconnect from Cultural Values
Current mainstream design and consumption often ignore cultural values like kaitiakitanga, causing a gap between environmental awareness and responsible daily actions.

Uncertainty about the Impact of Individual Actions
Users might feel that their individual efforts to reduce waste are insignificant in the face of larger environmental challenges.

Lack of Trust and Transparency in Sustainability Claims
Users may lack clear information about the true sustainability of products and materials.

Our dream

What we imagine

As emerging UX designers, we wanted to respond to urgent global challenges with more than technology—using empathy, lived experience, and cultural understanding. This project asked us to create a digital concept that is locally grounded yet globally relevant by pairing a Māori value with a UN Sustainable Development Goal.

Our Explore

What we find

Guided by SDG 12 (Responsible Consumption and Production), we explored the growing impact of material waste and throwaway culture in Aotearoa New Zealand. We found that many people want to upcycle and live more sustainably, but often lack the time, tools, skills, and support—prompting us to reframe sustainability as something powered by creativity and community, not sacrifice.

Our Story

What we think

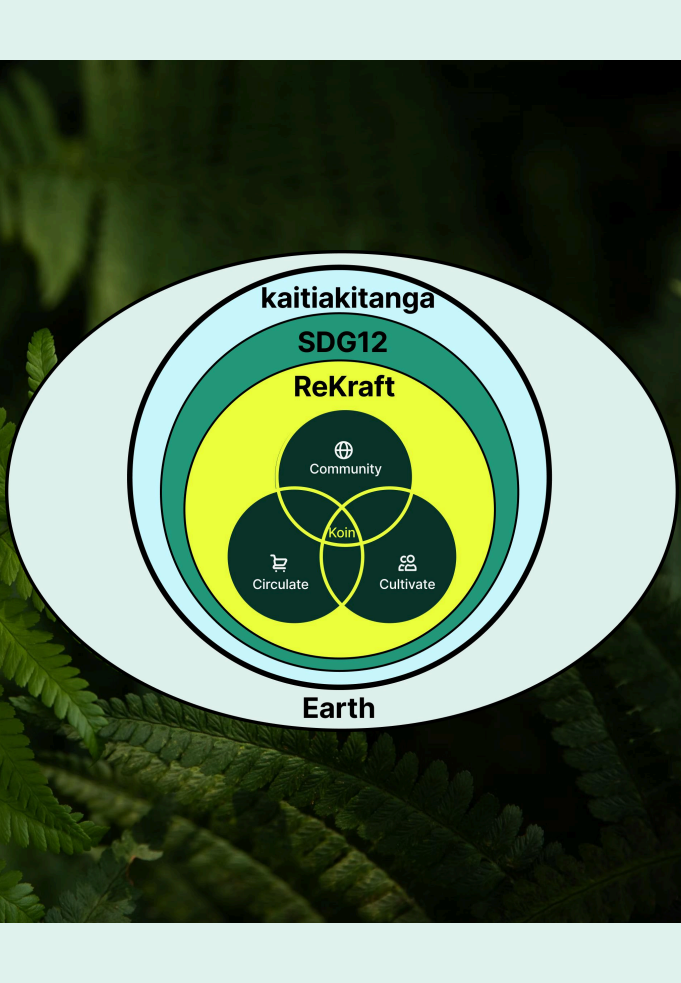
Rooted in kaitiakitanga—guardianship and care for the sky, land, and sea—we used this value as a cultural foundation for designing everyday sustainable practice. Our guiding question became: in a fast-paced, consumer-driven world, how might we help people reclaim mindful, sustainable habits through actions that feel meaningful, connected, and achievable?

Recycle
Reduce
Reuse

Solution

A values-anchored, community upcycling app

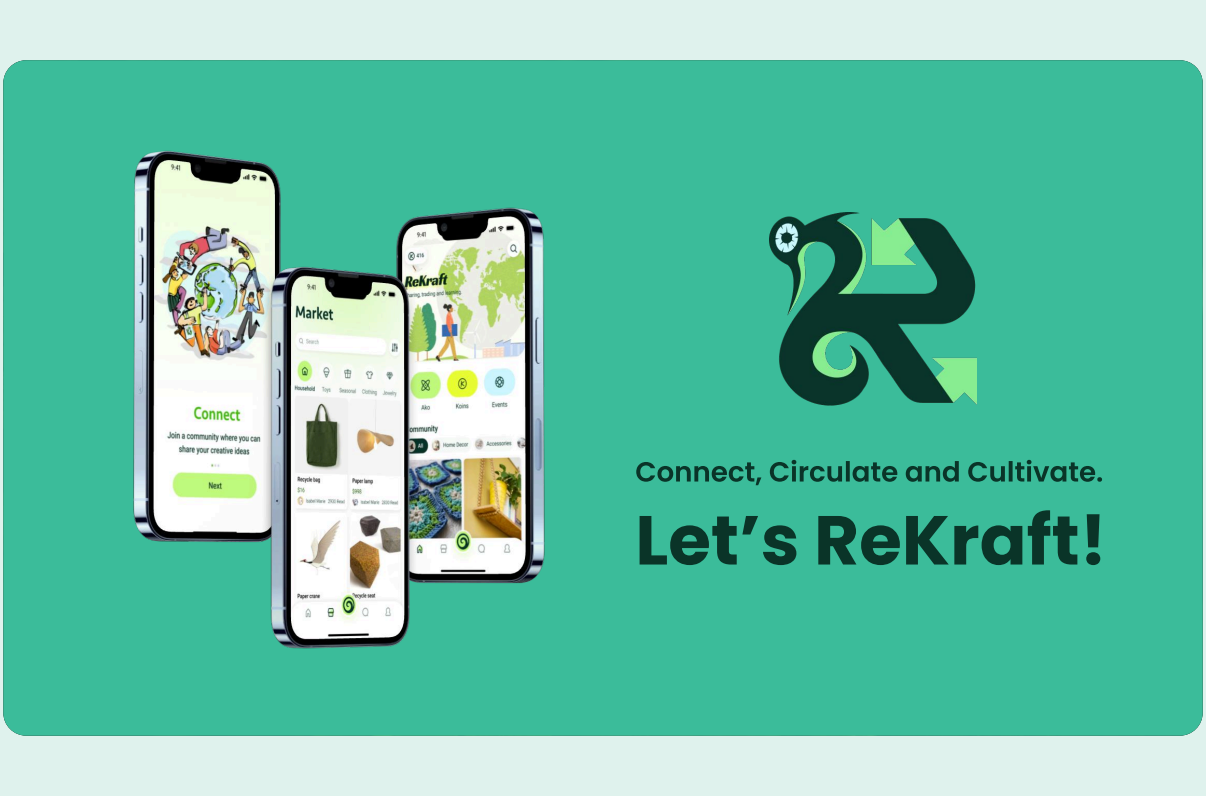
A mobile app grounded in Kaitiakitanga and SDG 12, organized around three linked modules—Community (share DIY practices and inspiration), Marketplace (trade, buy, swap, or share items and materials with origin/impact cues and a Koin value mechanism), and Ako/Learning (missions and micro-quizzes that teach guardianship principles)—to turn guardianship into concrete micro-actions supported by social motivation and transparent impact.


kaitiakitanga
SDG12
ReKraft
Community
Koin
Circulate
Cultivate
Earth

Outcome

Tangible Guardianship in Practice

The project delivered a culturally grounded MVP concept and hi-fi prototype showing how people can move fluidly between sharing ideas, obtaining materials, making/repairing, exchanging output, and learning values, while tracking their contributions; the result demonstrates tangible waste reduction behaviors, stronger community participation, and a respectful operationalization of Kaitiakitanga in contemporary UX.


Connect
Market
ReKraft
Connect, Circulate and Cultivate.
Let's ReKraft!

Feedback

Instructor & Usability Notes

Nuanced cultural integration
Clear, non-token understanding of Kaitiakitanga; strong articulation of reciprocal guardianship and implications for everyday practice.

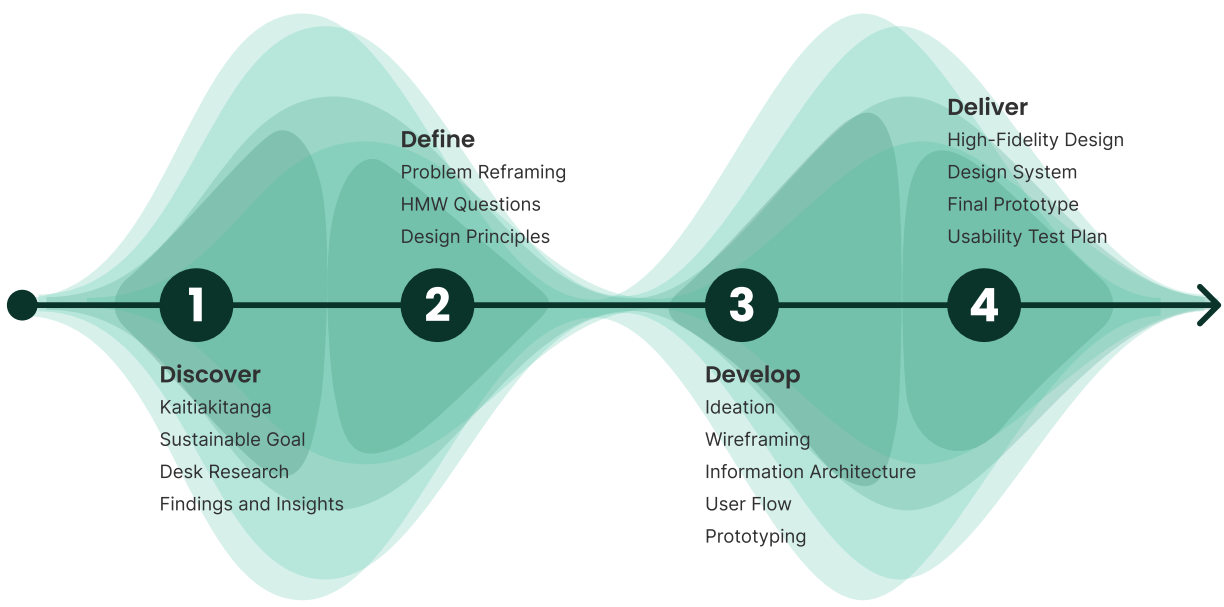
Research breadth at a professional level
Wide-ranging sources and perspectives that grounded concepting credibly.

Course Feedback

Design Process

A journey from grounding UX in Kaitiakitanga to translating stewardship into a share–trade–learn experience, validated through research-led iteration.

We combined desk and contextual research on Māori values, policies, precedents, and markets with co-analysis (affinity synthesis), then articulated actionable principles and scope. We translated these into information architecture, user flows, and iterative prototypes (low/mid/high fidelity), and validated with tasks that exercise community sharing, marketplace transactions, and learning missions; throughout, We applied culturally respectful integration of Te Ao Māori and ensured accessibility-first UI decisions.


1
Discover
Kaitiakitanga
Sustainable Goal
Desk Research
Findings and Insights
2
Define
Problem Reframing
HMW Questions
Design Principles
3
Develop
Ideation
Wireframing
Information Architecture
User Flow
Prototyping
4
Deliver
High-Fidelity Design
Design System
Final Prototype
Usability Test Plan

Discover

The discovery clarified the cultural foundation of Kaitiakitanga as reciprocal stewardship of land, sea, and sky, and mapped today's sustainability context where policy support and community initiatives exist but everyday reuse remains hard. Market and precedent reviews surfaced gaps: mainstream platforms excel at commerce or inspiration, but do not combine reuse literacy, community reciprocity, and Māori values. Technique scans explored AI recognition precedents for reuse suggestions; together, these inputs framed opportunities to connect cultural meaning with practical tools that lower barriers to action.

Research

The research combined literature and policy review, platform benchmarking, and community precedents (e.g., repair and tool-sharing initiatives) with a scan of AI-assisted identification for materials and ideas. It distilled what people need—ideas, access, skills, support, and trust—and how cultural framing influences motivation, pointing to a product direction that makes sustainability accessible, communal, and culturally resonant.

Findings

People want to upcycle but lack inspiration, local access to materials/tools, and confidence; trust and transparency about origins and impact influence participation; mainstream design overlooks Kaitiakitanga, weakening meaning and engagement; and the market supports learning and selling, but not an integrated reuse community experience.

01
Gaps
People want to upcycle but lack tools, skills, time and support.

02
Inspiration
Inspiration is scarce; many users don't see repurposing potential in everyday "waste."

03
Transparency
Trust and transparency affect participation (origin of materials, impact of actions).

04
Culture
Mainstream platforms overlook cultural values such as Kaitiakitanga, weakening meaning.

05
Motivation
Community motivation sustains behaviour more than one-off tips.

06
Waste
Making often generates waste; durability and repair are rarely taught.

Insights

Insights were reframed as design guidance: always pair Why (guardianship and SDG meaning) with How (step-by-step reuse actions); design for durability, repair, and low-waste making; build community reciprocity as a core value; respect Māori culture through appropriate collaboration and symbolism; and make origin/impact traceability visible to establish trust.

01
Activation
Lower the "first-step" barrier—provide simple, visual DIY guidance, local resource pointers, and micro-missions that convert intent into doable actions.

02
Discovery
Curate a Community stream that foregrounds transformations and recipes; make discovery effortless (tags, topics, seasonal kits).

03
Provenance
Surface origin/impact cues in the Marketplace and track contributions via Koin, reinforcing accountable guardianship.

04
Embedding
Embed Māori values respectfully—frame actions as guardianship, use appropriate motifs/storytelling, and align learning (Ako) with intergenerational care.

05
Reciprocity
Design for reciprocity—likes, replies, swaps, and tool-sharing; reward collective behaviours that extend lifecycles and reduce waste.

06
Circularity
Teach circular literacy (repair/maintenance, low-waste techniques) in Ako, and nudge longevity decisions in the Marketplace (filters, labels).

Define

Definition synthesized cultural, environmental, and community needs into explicit design principles, a problem statement, and scope boundaries, ensuring that Kaitiakitanga would be expressed through doing—micro-actions people can enact and track within a supportive community and transparent marketplace.

Problem Statement

How might we empower individuals and communities to reduce waste by creatively reusing materials, in ways that reflect the values of kaitiakitanga?

Design Principles

Design principles emphasize guardianship by doing (micro-missions and traceable actions), circular design literacy (repair/maintenance and lifecycle thinking), community reciprocity (sharing knowledge, tools, and materials), transparency and trust (origins, impact, authenticity), accessibility by default (plain language, legible type, inclusive navigation), and cultural respect (partnerships and appropriate motifs)—providing concrete direction for concepting and UI decisions.

Understand Context
What lies in the periphery of simplicity is definitely not peripheral.

Make it simple
Simplicity is about subtracting the obvious, and adding the meaningful.

For everyone
Make sure deliver a valuable experience to people regardless of their circumstances.

Be consistent
Use familiar conventions and apply them consistently.

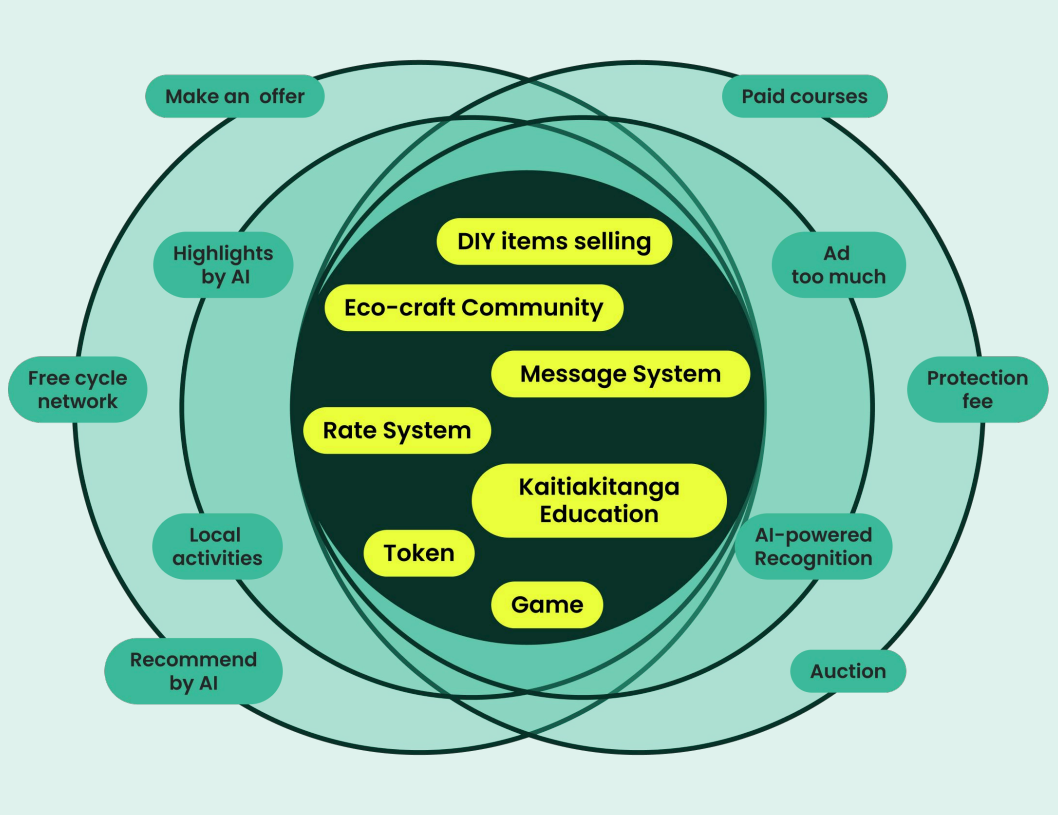
Develop

Development translated principles into a three-module product structure, refined flows around publishing, discovery, filtering, and missions, and prepared testing tasks that validate community sharing, market transactions, and learning progression, ensuring that practical steps remain visible and culturally meaningful.

Ideation

Ideation surveyed adjacent directions (DIY reuse platform, energy sharing, trail-based cultural learning, guardianship challenges) and converged on a waste-to-treasure community platform for the strongest alignment of SDG 12, feasibility, and user appeal, with a commitment to deepen Māori value integration beyond aesthetics.

Functions


Make an offer
Paid courses
Highlights by AI
Ad too much
Free cycle network
Protection fee
Local activities
AI-powered Recognition
Recommend by AI
Auction
DIY items selling
Eco-craft Community
Message System
Rate System
Kaitiakitanga Education
Token
Game

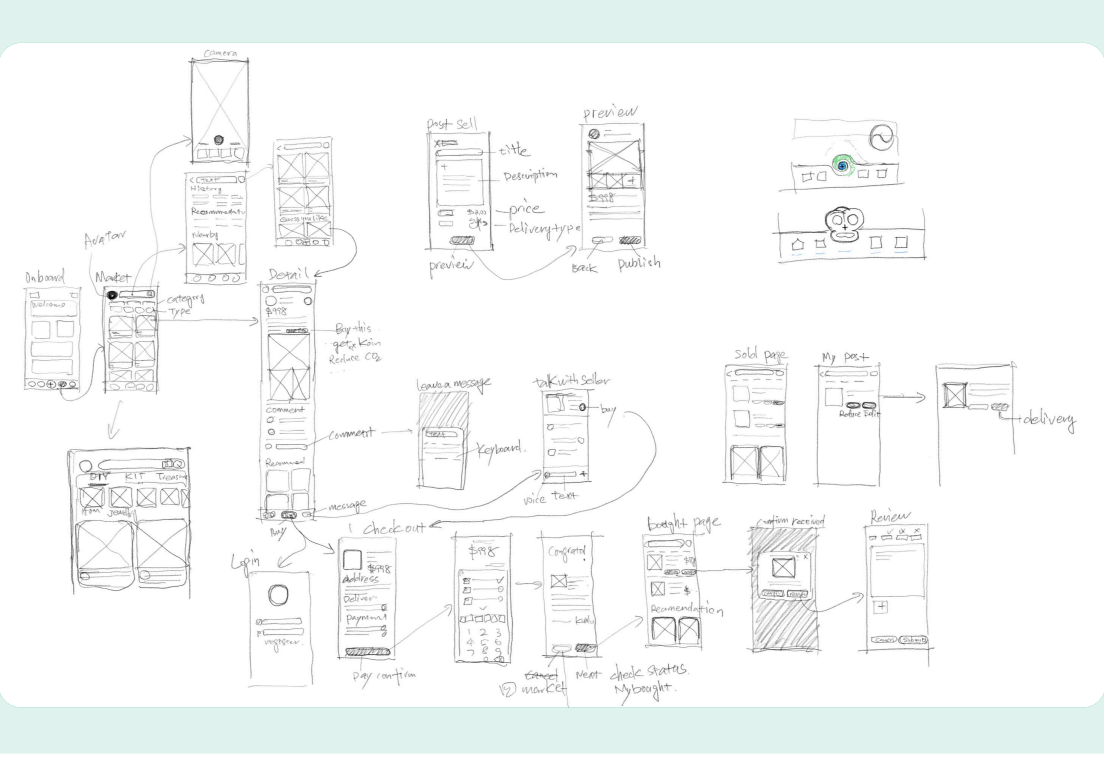
User Journey

The journey moves from discovering ideas to accessing materials and tools, making or repairing items, sharing or exchanging outcomes, and learning values while tracking impact. Pain points at entry (no ideas), access (materials/tools), and confidence (skills/impact) informed module prioritization and the inclusion of transparent cues and micro-missions.

Journey Map

Stage→	Before (Connect)→	During (Circulate)→	After (Cultivate)
Goals	Find inspiration, understand guardianship, see what's possible	Acquire/share materials; make/repair; exchange outcomes	Track impact; teach/learn; contribute to community
Thoughts	"How can I reuse what I have?"	"Is this safe/viable? Where do I get tools?"	"Did we make a difference?"
Feelings	Curious → Hesitant	Focused → Empowered	Proud → Motivated
Pain Points	Tracks progress and prepares inspection	Limited access; credibility of listings; making waste	Impact is invisible; learning is fragmented
Opportunities	Onboarding with stories, saved starter kits, local resources	Marketplace origin/impact cues, tool-sharing, checklists, low-waste tips	Koin impact tracking, missions/quizzes, seasonal challenges, community recognition

Wireframe



Information Architecture

The IA organizes the product into Community (posts, tutorials, inspiration), Market (listings, filters, buy/swap/share, Koin impact), and Ako (starter pack, missions, quizzes) with supporting layers for Messages, Profile/Koin, and Search. It prioritizes clarity, reciprocity, and traceability so users can see what things are, where they come from, how they impact, and what to do next.

Homepage

Community	Market	Ako	Message	Profile
Post	Buy	Starter Pack	Chat	Settings
Sell	Search	Mission	Likes	User information
	Category	Quiz	Search	Koins
		Koins	Comments	My footsteps
		Events	Follow	My trade

Key user flows

Flows streamline posting and discussion, efficient filtering and trustworthy listing evaluation, and mission-based learning with rewards. Each flow foregrounds value transparency (origin/impact cues, Koin states), cultural narratives (mission framing tied to guardianship), and low-friction actions to transform intent into practice.

1 Publish a Community post (DIY idea)

Homepage Koru → Post → Add images → Add title & tags → Describe steps/materials → Publish → Discuss & follow-ups

2 Trade/Share in Marketplace

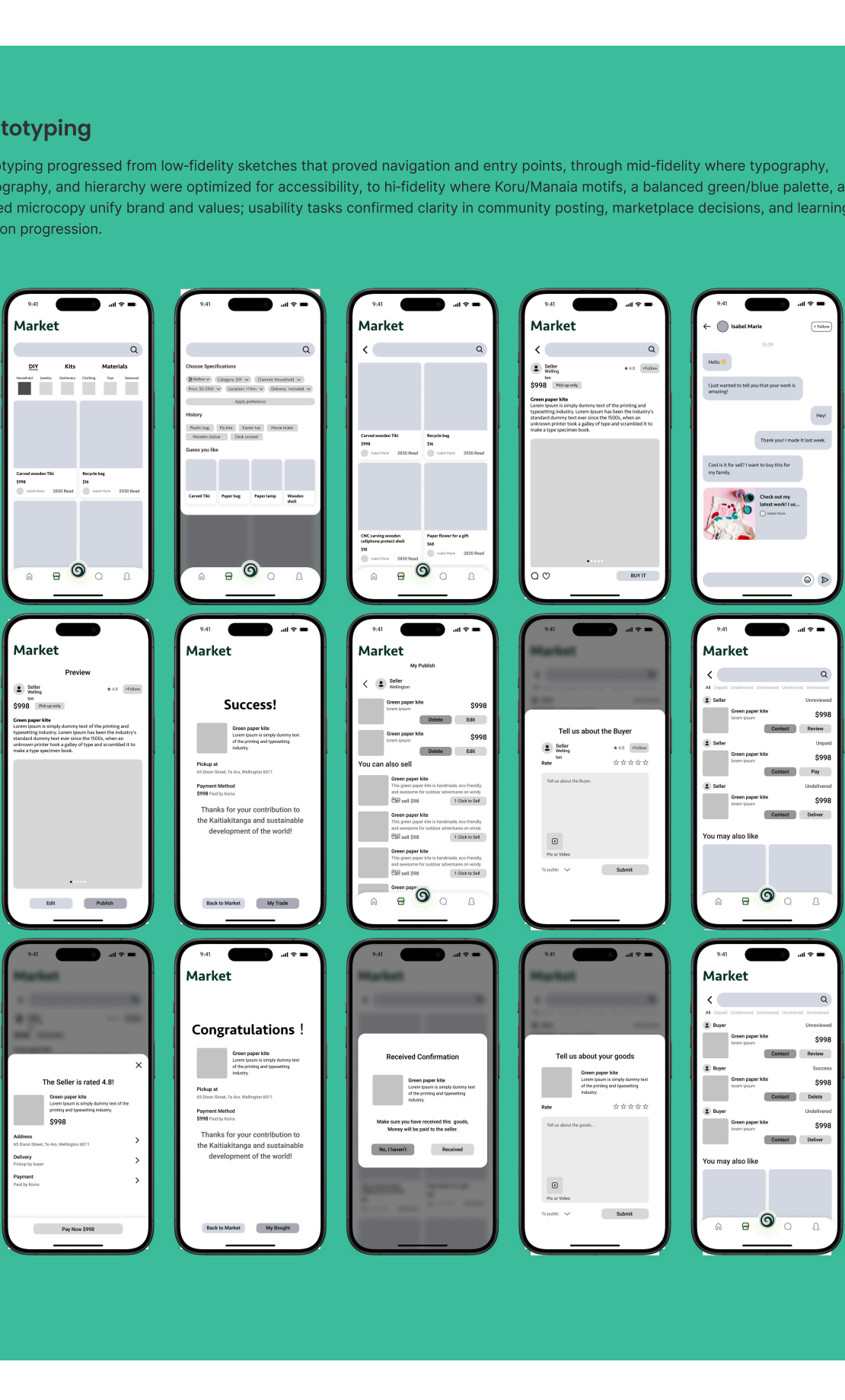
Homepage Koru → Sell → Browse & filter → Open listing → Check origin/impact cues → Buy/Swap → Confirm & track

3 Complete an Ako mission

Homepage Koru → Learn → Open Kaitiaki Starter Pack → Read short lesson → Take quiz → Earn Koin → Unlock next mission

Prototyping

Prototyping progressed from low-fidelity sketches that proved navigation and entry points, through mid-fidelity where typography, iconography, and hierarchy were optimized for accessibility, to hi-fidelity where Koru/Manaia motifs, a balanced green/blue palette, and refined microcopy unify brand and values; usability tasks confirmed clarity in community posting, marketplace decisions, and learning mission progression.


Market
Success!
Congratulations !
Tell us about the Buyer
Tell us about your goods
Received Confirmation
The Seller is rated 4.8!
You may also like

Deliver

Delivery comprises a coherent MVP concept and hi-fi prototype with principles, IA, user flows, and testing tasks—ready to inform pilot development and stakeholder discussions.

Design system

The design system raises body text to 16px/1rem for legibility, reserves 14px for captions, and verifies WCAG contrast across type/background pairs. Colour harmonizes land–sea–sky tones while preserving high-contrast states; iconography and spacing adhere to consistent rules. The logo blends Manaia symbolism with circular arrows in a K/R hybrid to express guardianship and recycling; illustrations for onboarding visualize Connect, Circulate, Cultivate. Together these assets ensure cultural grounding with accessibility-first implementation.

Typography

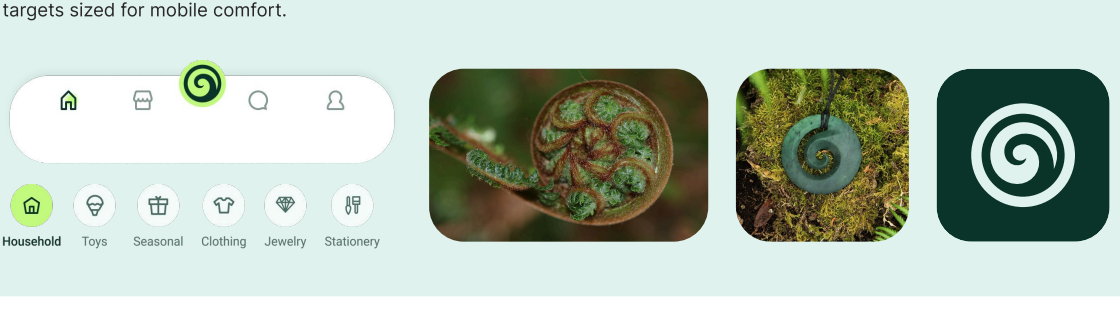
Seravek is used as the primary typeface for key headings and standout moments because its subtly curved, modern sans-serif forms can nod to the organic, flowing line qualities often associated with Māori visual language while still feeling contemporary and digital; Roboto is used as the secondary typeface for body copy and UI labels to prioritise clarity and consistent legibility across screens, with accessibility in mind by setting 16px / 1rem as the minimum body size and reserving 14px for secondary text such as captions and metadata.

Primary
Seravek

Secondary
Roboto

Icon

Soft, rounded line icons (inspired by Koru curvature) for clarity and warmth; consistent sizes/contrast across modules; touch targets sized for mobile comfort.


Household
Toys
Seasonal
Clothing
Jewelry
Stationery

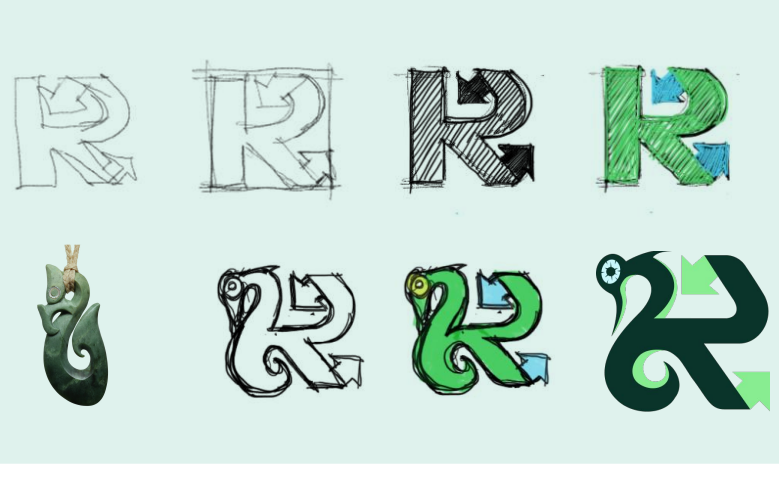
Colour

Harmonised green/blue palette (land–sea–sky) with dark tones for text; state colours meet WCAG contrast; restrained use of accent colours to avoid visual noise.

#C2FA7D
#EBFF3D
#0A3429
#CAF8FF

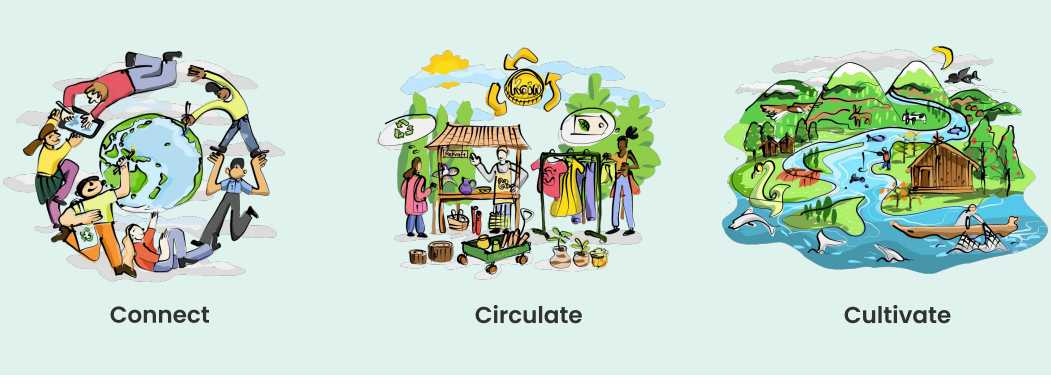
Brand

Manaia-inspired mark blended with a K/R hybrid and a universal recycle arrow—communicates guardianship + circularity without tokenism; legible at small sizes.



Illustration

Onboarding trio—Connect, Circulate, Cultivate—uses simple, high-contrast scenes of people and nature to link everyday actions with Kaitiakitanga; decorative restraint for accessibility.



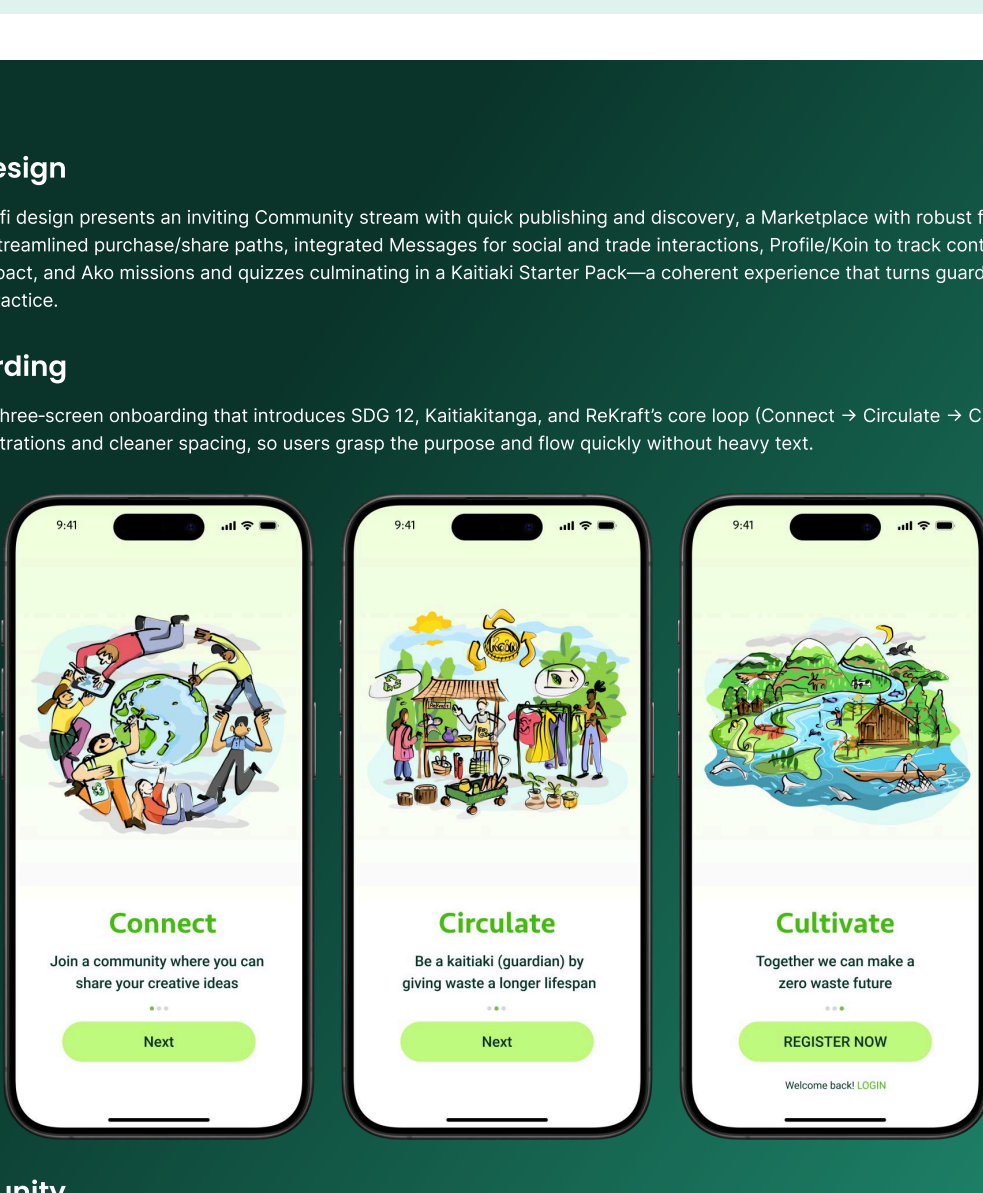
Connect
Circulate
Cultivate

Final design

The final hi-fi design presents an inviting Community stream with quick publishing and discovery, a Marketplace with robust filters, impact cues, and streamlined purchase/share paths, integrated Messages for social and trade interactions, Profile/Koin to track contributions and eco-impact, and Ako missions and quizzes culminating in a Kaitiaki Starter Pack—a coherent experience that turns guardianship into everyday practice.

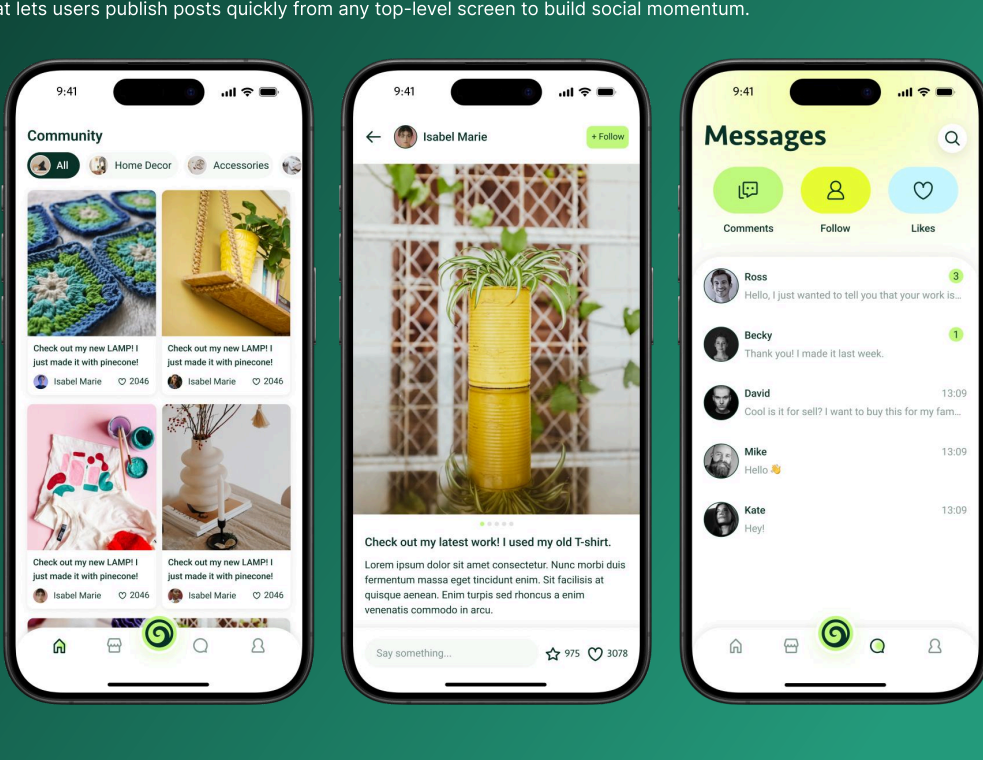
Onboarding

A concise, three-screen onboarding that introduces SDG 12, Kaitiakitanga, and ReKraft's core loop (Connect → Circulate → Cultivate) with original illustrations and cleaner spacing, so users grasp the purpose and flow quickly without heavy text.


Connect
Join a community where you can share your creative ideas
Next
Circulate
Be a kaitiaki (guardian) by giving waste a longer lifespan
Next
Cultivate
Together we can make a zero waste future
REGISTER NOW
Welcome back! LOGIN

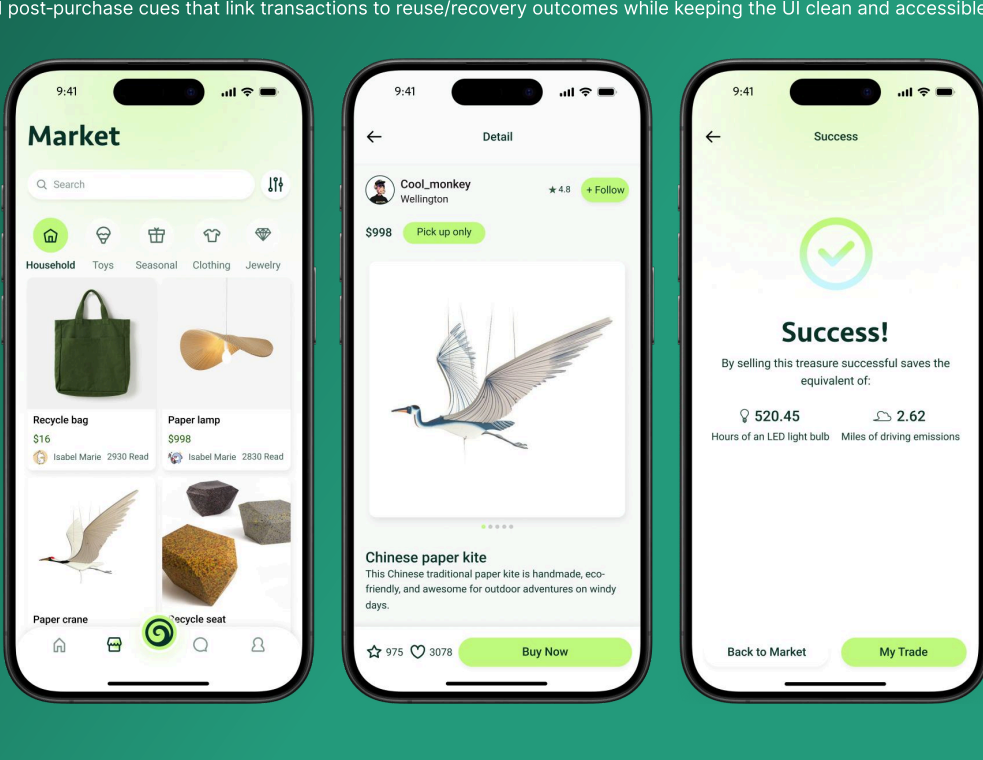
Community

A lightweight, inspiration-first feed designed for fast engagement: illustration-led storytelling, scannable category browsing, and a central shortcut that lets users publish posts quickly from any top-level screen to build social momentum.


Community
Home Decor
Accessories
Isabel Marie
Follow
Check out my latest work! I used my old T-shirt.
Messages
Comments
Follow
Likes
Ross
Becky
David
Mike
Kate

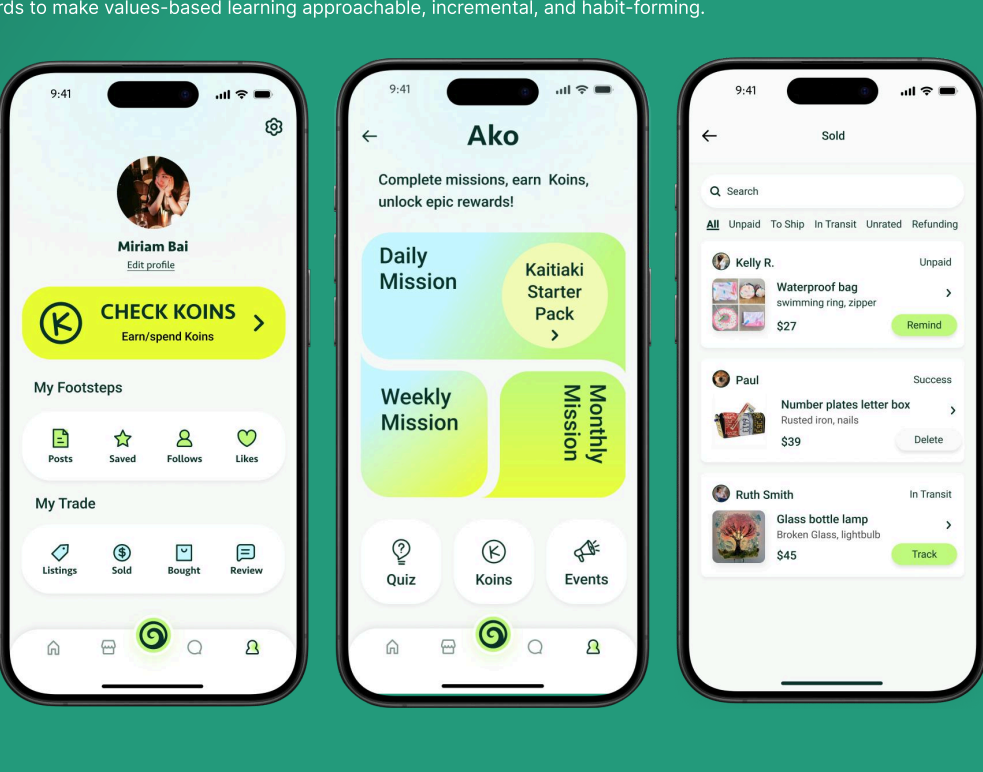
Market

A familiar commerce flow (browse → filter/search → detail → purchase) optimized for circular exchange, with simplified filters, clearer layouts, and post-purchase cues that link transactions to reuse/recovery outcomes while keeping the UI clean and accessible.


Market
Household
Toys
Seasonal
Clothing
Jewelry
Recycle bag
Paper lamp
Paper crane
Recycle seat
Detail
Cool_monkey
Wellington
$998
Pick up only
Chinese paper kite
Buy Now
Success!
By selling this treasure successful saves the equivalent of:
520.45
Hours of an LED light bulb
2.62
Miles of driving emissions
Back to Market
My Trade

Ako

A bite-sized learning hub built around the Kaitiaki Starter Pack, missions, and quizzes, using a roadmap-style progress view and Koin-linked rewards to make values-based learning approachable, incremental, and habit-forming.


Miriam Bai
Edit profile
CHECK KOINS
Earn/spend Koins
My Footsteps
Posts
Saved
Follows
Likes
My Trade
Listings
Sold
Bought
Review
Ako
Complete missions, earn Koins, unlock epic rewards!
Daily Mission
Kaitiaki Starter Pack
Weekly Mission
Monthly Mission
Quiz
Koins
Events
Sold
Kelly R.
Waterproof bag
Paul
Number plates letter box
Ruth Smith
Glass bottle lamp

Retrospective

HENEX Method Recipe

Aim: Turn sustainability into an everyday share–trade–learn loop—clear modules, playful micro-actions, visible impact.

Methods (short mapping):

- Mission-First Navigation — Community / Marketplace / Ako as goals-first IA.
- Small-Step Actions — Simple micro-behaviours (share/swap/learn) with feedback.
- Visible Circular Loop — Show reuse/repair/exchange touchpoints across the journey.
- Impact Dashboard — Contributions and outcomes made visible.
- Trust & Cooperation Rules — Safe exchange norms; basic reputation/moderation.
- Purpose Story Script — A narrative spine connecting actions to meaning.

Result: Participation rises and repeat actions become more natural—users see their impact and keep engaging.

Reflection

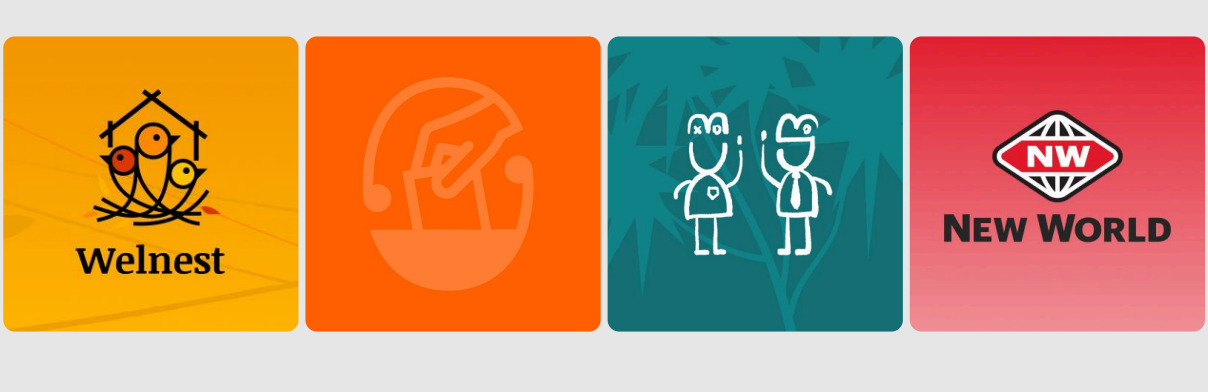
This project demonstrates that cultural integration is most powerful when expressed through everyday agency, not just visuals: reframing detailed findings as principles clarified decisions; adopting accessibility standards (type scale, contrast, targets) improved real-world usability; and while usability testing achieved task-level validation, future work should broaden sampling and deepen analysis to strengthen evidence. Respectful collaboration—with Māori practitioners and community groups—will further enhance authenticity and nuance.

Next steps

Next steps include formal co-design with Māori artisans and community organizations, extending the Koin model (conversion, exchange rules, and impact tracking), building a pilot with local maker spaces and instrumented analytics for waste reduction and engagement, expanding to multilingual and multi-platform versions, and integrating local events and tool-sharing directories to grow the ecosystem around everyday guardianship.

View Prototype

Related Projects


Welnest
NW
NEW WORLD

Back to Works
To the Top

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